

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the type written original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Nearing the big city, five hours late, I asked the baggage-master about possible connections to Detroit. "The last train for Detroit is scheduled for some time about 6 P.M., and now it is nearly 10:30". Besides, that train was supposed to leave from a station about a twenty minute trolley ride from that of the "Burlington". Waiting for a transfer about half way over, it took me at least that, in the misty night air.

How wonderful, however, and Thanks be to God; almost as though waiting for poor Father S., up went the megaphone the moment he entered: "All aboard!..... and Detroit. "All aboard" --"Well, God bless them" he though--"They'll wait now till I get my clergy-fare ticket." So they did. God bless them again. Now I could say Holy Mass at St. Bonaventure's in the morning, and what to me was imperative as Sacristan, I could reach Yonkers, N. Y. for the dedication of the new Sacred Heart Church next day. Thanks be to God, a million!

Pardon this digression--longer than it ought to be already --but you'll be curious about the referred to mystery. Well, then as now, I was disappointed at no appearance of our beautiful Trimbelle, gracing Diamond Bluff, etc. However, notwithstanding the terrific storm that raged at the time of our passage that other trip, I had watched sharply and finally had the satisfaction of seeing what I concluded must be no other than the delightful little stream I looked for. Now I remembered my conclusion at that time; that it was about two miles below the Bluff. Pardon such digression.

We had been making it a sort of rule to say the Rosary starting out on our longer trips. Today, however, we had gone a good twenty miles over hills and through beautiful valleys, and now speeding for said mountain-head, Fr. Maurice remarked: "Say, we've not said our Rosary. (Father) Barney it's your turn to lead." "Okay" and the later started: "In the name....."

You may wonder how we could pray under such circumstances. without distractions, etc. Well, I am not going to tell you the secret today, for the simple reason I do not know it myself. Rather, we might ask: "Do such distractions really displease the Good God?" For myself, I do not think they do. Rather, I would answer, as I have occasion now and then to assure scrupulous souls: "No, Jesus is no crank. He knows that we are not angels, but poor sinners; every one of us." At all events, as we rounded said mountain-head, such a distraction